



ASSASSIN'S CREED REVELATIONS

So long and thanks for all the kills

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Assassin's Creed Revelations bids a fond adieu to two legends and an era. You get to play all the three protagonists you've played till now i.e. Desmond Miles, the bartender turned assassin from New York; Ezio Auditore, the flamboyant and vindictive assassin from Florence and last but not the least Altair, the mentor and master assassin from Levant; all in this one game. Being the last game of the Altair-Ezio quadrilogy, it wraps up all the loose ends of both, Ezio's and Altair's story arcs, paving way for the next offering of the series.

The plot is filled to the brim and has more twists in it than a corkscrew. *Revelations* primarily unfolds in Constantinople under Ottoman rule at the cusp of the Renaissance. Among the three, Ezio's story is most compelling and takes up most of the game, who is at the same time battling both, mid-life crisis and the Templars. He goes to Constantinople to find five keys of Altair's lost library where he's thrust into the social and political turmoil in the region, which is closely associated with mission at hand. Then there are the brief interludes where you play Altair, reliving events occurring at different stages in his life. You can also play Desmond in a first-person platformer segment, which looks very Portal-esque (a part of you waits for the Handheld Portal Gun in the next room). You interact with the environment in a convoluted 3D-tetris sort of way, placing blocks to tackle the environment and in this

process learn more about Desmond's life.

The core gameplay hasn't changed much though – you're still an assassin that stalks, meets, chases, stabs and kills people. There are a myriad of missions to choose from, but they tend to become repetitive after a while, though the Altair and Desmond segments break the monotony. A special mention of the beautifully crafted underground caverns, river chases and puzzle sequences before you find the keys, they look nothing short of grand. Then there's the "optional" Den Defense segment, where you stand on a roof and protect your den from Templar attacks, by directing your troops to proper positions. This is one place that the game fails miserably. Who in a sane frame of mind would want to settle for tactical gameplay, when there are so many people to be garroted.

Talking about newly introduced weapons, there's the hook blade, which coupled with zip-lines on buildings reportedly reduces the travelling time by 30 per cent; free-running just became much more interesting. You can use it to vault over enemies blocking your way, tackle enemies without killing them and of course still use

it to stab people in the back. Then there are the bombs. The bomb crafting system allows the creation of about 300 different types of bombs, some of them particularly interesting – for instance, the stink bomb or the grisly, blood bomb. The premise is interesting but it isn't practical as counter kills and combo moves are much faster in dispatching enemies.

Graphics-wise, the game is good. Though, it does tend to blur in some places with discernible clipping. Overall, characters and environs are much more vivid and rich. The game has a brooding, sort of melancholic air about it. A special shout out to Constantinople, it's perhaps the best designed city till now. Vivid and colorful, it comes alive on the screen. The soundtrack is brilliant and perfectly in sync with the game.

A strong story line and gameplay has been, and is, the hallmark of this franchise. Though a more immersive and faster combat would have been welcome. A few shortcomings aside, this is a game definitely not be missed especially by AC fans who've followed Ezio's and Altair's life till now. You owe to yourself to see them through to the end. ✨

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Genre: Third person action adventure, Sandbox

Developer: Ubisoft Montreal

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